

Standard Operating Procedure

Critical Laboratory Result Communication

«Hospital Name» — Supports AAC.6.g

SOP No.	[Hospital to define]	Version	1.0
Effective Date	_____	Review Frequency	Annual, or on change
Prepared By	Quality Coordinator Name: _____ Signature: _____		
Approved By	Medical Superintendent Name: _____ Signature: _____		

1. Purpose

This SOP describes how «Hospital Name» communicates a critical laboratory result the moment it is ready, with a documented read-back, so the treating team can act without delay.

2. Scope

Applies to every laboratory staff member authorised to report results, for every test with a defined critical limit — including outsourced investigations.

3. Responsibility

Authorised Reporter: identifies a critical result and calls it in immediately.

Receiving Clinical Staff: reads back the value to confirm accuracy before acting.

4. Procedure

1. Check every result against the documented critical limits for that test, including outsourced investigation results.
2. The moment a result crosses a critical limit, call a person from the treating team — do not wait for a routine report run.
3. State clearly: patient name, unique ID, date and time of sample collection, test name, result, unit, and reference range.
4. Ask the recipient to read back the value to confirm it was heard correctly, and log that the read-back was done.
5. Record your own identity and the recipient's identity in the Critical Result Communication Log, with date and time.

5. Records

Supported by Records 19–21 of the AAC.6 Required Records pack.

6. Related Documents

- HCO_AAC_6_v2_REWRITE_DRAFT — AAC.6 policy

7. Review

Reviewed annually.

8. References

- The Joint Commission. (2026). National Patient Safety Goals: Report critical results of tests and diagnostic procedures on a timely basis (Goal NPSG.02.03.01).
<https://www.jointcommission.org/en-us/standards/national-patient-safety-goals>